



Ethics Committee Meeting February 12th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dqT8lBbpey8
Publication Date	2025-02-13T12:15:36Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Muncie Ethics Commission: Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date: (Prior to March 1st implementation window)

Body: Muncie Ethics Commission

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:00:25](#) Presiding member Chip Taylor called the inaugural meeting of the Muncie Ethics Commission to order, noting roll call to establish attendance and formally record members present.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Susan Dylan, WC Edwards, James low, and Charles "Chip" Taylor.
 - **Members Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Charles "Chip" Taylor.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** [00:00:25](#) Roll call was conducted to establish official attendance. Following the appointment of the fifth member, a brief recess was taken to allow the city clerk to join the dais [00:04:46](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:** *Not applicable (inaugural meeting).*
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

A. 00:00:44 Appointment of the Fifth Commission Member

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chip Taylor / Commission Board.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The commission reviewed the statutory requirements for the fifth commissioner (must be a Muncie resident, cannot be an elected/appointed official, city employee, member of another city board/commission, or political party officer/employee, and cannot have a business organization paid >\$300,000 by the city in the previous calendar year). Sandra Whitaker was nominated and seconded 00:01:46. Whitaker introduced her background as a retired Muncie Community Schools administrator with postgraduate studies and professional development involving human resources and ethics, and prior service on the Ethics Advisory Committee 00:02:40.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote 00:04:35.

B. 00:07:13 Election of Commission Officers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chip Taylor.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The commission held internal elections for its leadership positions:
 - **Chair:** Charles "Chip" Taylor nominated and seconded 00:07:19. **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:07:46.
 - **Vice Chair:** Susan Dylan nominated and seconded 00:08:13. **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:08:31.
 - **Secretary:** James low nominated and seconded 00:08:56. **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:09:12.

C. 00:09:28 Establishment of Regular Meeting Schedule & Location

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chip Taylor.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding building availability in City Hall Auditorium. To accommodate necessary workload prior to the March 1st deadline to accept complaints and provide flexibility, regular meetings were proposed for the second and fourth Wednesdays of each month.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** A motion was made and seconded to hold regular meetings on the **2nd and 4th Wednesdays of each month at 6:00 p.m.** in the City Hall Auditorium. Approved by Voice Vote 00:12:34.

D. 00:13:35 Presentation: Overview of Ethics Ordinance & Commission Responsibilities

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dan Gibson (City Council Attorney) and Aubrey Chris (Assistant City Attorney).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Attorneys Gibson and Chris provided an extensive legal overview of the adopted ethics ordinance, which creates a code of ethics, establishes the ethics commission, sets complaint/enforcement procedures, and outlines training/reporting requirements.
 - **Jurisdiction:** Current/former elected officials, appointed officials, board/commission members, and city officers/employees solely regarding the ethics code.
 - **Authority:** Issue advisory opinions (via formal request form), conduct investigations, issue findings, refer violations to law enforcement or Corporation Counsel, compel document production/witness attendance, and retain legal counsel.
 - **Limitations:** The commission *cannot* discipline employees, remove board/commission members or elected officials, issue fines, or render ordinance violation judgments.
 - **Process Highlights:** 7-day notice requirement to respondents, 15-day initial executive session review window, and options for dismissal, agreed resolution, or public hearings.

E. 00:37:42 Discussion on General Rules, Procedures, & Complaint Forms

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chip Taylor, Susan Dylan, and Dan Gibson.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed draft general operating rules (modeled after the Muncie Police Merit commission) and preliminary complaint intake forms. Discussions centered on whistleblower protections, confidentiality vs. public access laws (Open Door Law and APRA), consultation with Public Access Counselor Luke Britt regarding complainant anonymity and notice mandates, and developing clear procedures for future investigative hearings and web-based transparency portals.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general public comments were recorded during this portion of the transcript, as the floor was dedicated to commission members and legal counsel discussing internal governance and ordinance implementation.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Commission members will collaborate with the City Clerk (Belinda) to establish official @munsey.gov ethics email accounts, update website links on MuniCode, and design printable/online complaint intake forms.
 - Training schedules for city administrators, boards, and officials will be coordinated with the legal department.
 - **Adjournment:** 00:06:28 (Note: transcript records the formal motion and voice vote to adjourn at the conclusion of business). **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:06:30.
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